

mitzvah cost our family \$20,000! She told me we saved some money for it, and both my grandmothers helped out, but a chunk definitely went on credit cards. *Oy gevalt.*

I balk over the numbers, but the memories are what matter most to my mom. Every time we talk about this party, she reminds me how, at the end of the night, I lay on the floor in my dress, not wanting to take it off because if I took it off, then “it was really over.” She cherishes that. It was priceless to her. Still, I can’t believe my parents spent \$20,000 on a thirteen-year-old’s birthday party. Maybe it’s because of this experience that I’ve never cared about a wedding. Been there, done that, have the yarmulkes to prove it.

Yet I’ve only actually been to four weddings as an adult. A lot of what I know about them comes from movies like *My Best Friend’s Wedding*, which I was weirdly obsessed with in the fourth grade—not because I wanted to get married, but because I liked the singing and had a crush on Julia Roberts (who looks kind of like my mom; dissect *that*, people). I was shocked when a badass feminist writer friend told me once at dinner how she thought about her own wedding a lot. Weren’t we not supposed be into that? (Trick question: Feminism is about choice.)

Personally I think paying thousands of dollars for one day of your life or going into debt for a big party like my parents did for my bat mitzvah (or both) is irresponsible. Why not use that money for a down payment on a house? Or donate it to the Trevor Project? What’s the point of a wedding? Is it just a tradition that has continued on solely because people don’t want to elope and break their grandparents’ fragile, elderly hearts? Is it to piss off your middle school frenemy?

Though I am not personally a proponent of over-the-top weddings, I don’t want to perpetuate the stereotype that it’s only straight girls who go gaga over weddings. I have queer friends of all genders who are very into weddings. Possibly it’s because gay people are so excited to finally be able to participate in the wedding-industrial complex that we’re going overboard to have the same privileges as straight people—which honestly, I can get behind. We have so many years of seven-layer cakes to catch up on before we’re “over” weddings. (And any baker who won’t make a wedding cake for an LGBTQ couple should be forced